

100 Advanced C1-C2 Collocation Activities Guide: A Master Framework

1. Module 1: Advanced Register & Formality Upgrades

In the sphere of professional English, register flexibility is not merely a linguistic asset; it is a strategic tool for establishing authority and institutional belonging. The ability to navigate between informal spoken discourse and the precise, often legalistic, terminology of official notices signals a high level of communicative competence. Shifting from common phrasal verbs like "get off" to "alight from" or "throw away" to "dispose of" demonstrates a mastery of context that is essential for leadership and administrative roles. This module focuses on refining this sensitivity to register, ensuring that the learner can calibrate their language to meet the rigorous demands of professional environments.

Activities 1–10: Register Refinement

Field, Activity 1, Activity 2, Activity 3, Activity 4, Activity 5

Title, Transit Protocol, Waste Management, Press Release: Jobs, Pricing Strategy, Market Forecasts

Skill, Writing, Writing, Writing, Writing, Speaking

Subskill, Formal Notices, Regulatory Policy, Journalism, Business Comms, Executive Briefing

CEFR Level, C1, C2, C1, C1, C2

Objective, Use formal transit collocations., Apply legalistic disposal terms., Use dramatic media collocations., Apply impact-oriented verbs., Use high-level movement terms.

Instructions, Rewrite a municipal bus directive for an official city ordinance., Draft a corporate policy for industrial battery disposal., Transform a standard corporate announcement into a punchy news headline., Rewrite a discount announcement for an industry journal., Brief the board on rapid budget increases using financial metaphors.

Task Prompt, ""Don't get off while the bus is moving."" ""Put unwanted batteries in the bin we gave you."" ""The company is going to make 200 people redundant."" ""The airline has decided to cut prices drastically."" ""Government spending will increase very fast this year.""

Expected Answer, Passengers must not alight from the bus while it is in motion., Please dispose of unwanted items in the receptacle provided ., ""COMPUTER FACTORY TO AXE JOBS "" ""AIRLINE SLASHES PRICES "" ""Government spending will rocket this year.""

Difficulty, Advanced, Mastery, Advanced, Advanced, Mastery

Activity Type, Register Shift, Policy Drafting, Headline Transformation, Register Shift, Scenario Simulation

Field, Activity 6, Activity 7, Activity 8, Activity 9, Activity 10

Title, Legal Warnings, Procurement Basics, Capital Acquisition, Institutional Entry, Professional Inquiries

Skill, Writing, Writing, Speaking, Writing, Speaking

Subskill, Law Enforcement, Contractual English, Finance, Formal Signage, Media Interviews

CEFR Level, C1, C2, C2, C1, C2

Objective, Use performative legal phrases., Use procurement terminology., Use funding collocations., Use formal physical instructions., Use journalistic interview terms.

Instructions, Draft a warning sign for a private secure facility., Synthesize a sentence regarding the formal bidding process for a state project., Describe the strategic necessity of securing expansion funds., Create a formal instruction for a pedestrian bridge in a university setting., Question a person of interest for a formal investigative report.

Task Prompt, ""People who walk here without asking will be taken to court."" , ""We need to send in a document stating our price for the job."" , ""We need to get money to expand our business."" , ""Bikers must get off their bikes here."" , ""The police asked the man questions for hours.""

Expected Answer, Trespassers will be prosecuted., We must submit a tender for the new stadium., We need to raise capital to expand., Cyclists must dismount here., Police quiz suspect in murder enquiry.

Difficulty, Advanced, Mastery, Mastery, Advanced, Mastery

Activity Type, Legal Framing, Register Shift, Business Simulation, Register Shift, Error Correction

Linguist's Note: Newspaper English collocations such as "axe jobs" or "slashes prices" are designed for maximum dramatic impact within restrictive character counts. While highly effective for capturing attention, they differ significantly from standard business prose, which favors more measured collocations like "make redundant" or "reduce costs." Mastering these distinctions allows a professional to choose between the urgency of a headline and the institutional stability of a formal report. Mastering register is the foundational step toward achieving the precision and nuance required for executive-level communication.

2. Module 2: De-Lexicalized Verb Precision (Make/Do/Get/Take/Have/Pay)

At the C1-C2 level, the "de-lexicalized verb" challenge becomes a significant differentiator. High-frequency verbs like *make*, *do*, and *pay* carry little semantic weight on their own but become powerful tools of precision when paired with the correct nouns. A functional speaker might say "do a mistake," but a fluent professional instinctively "makes a mistake." This precision is essential because these verbs form the bedrock of daily professional interactions—from "making a contribution" in a board meeting to "paying tribute" at a diplomatic event.

Activities 11–20: Verb Precision in Context

Field, Activity 11, Activity 12, Activity 13, Activity 14, Activity 15

Title, The Boardroom Contribution, The Favor Exchange, The Retirement Speech, The Client Compliment, The Project Adjustment

Skill, Speaking, Writing, Speaking, Speaking, Writing

Subskill, Meeting Participation, Interoffice Email, Public Speaking, Client Relations, Project Management

CEFR Level, C1, C2, C2, C1, C1

Objective, "Use ""make"" with abstract nouns.", "Differentiate ""do"" for favors.", "Use ""pay"" in formal contexts.", "Use ""pay"" for social etiquette.", "Use ""make"" for alterations."

Instructions, Formally contribute an idea during a high-level strategic planning meeting., Negotiate an inter-departmental favor within a high-stakes corporate hierarchy., Deliver a formal speech to honor a senior partner's lifelong career., Express professional appreciation for

a client's recent performance.,Formally document a significant change to the project's master schedule.

Task Prompt,"""I want to say something useful to this discussion.""", """"Could you help me with this report?""", """"I want to say how great Jack's work was for the company.""", """"I want to tell her she did a great job.""", """"The manager is going to change the plan."""

Expected Answer,I'd like to make a contribution to the discussion.,Could you do me a favor and review the quarterly report?,I would like to pay tribute to Jack's dedication.,I wanted to pay her a compliment on the report.,The manager will make some changes to the plan.

Difficulty,Advanced,Mastery,Mastery,Advanced,Advanced

Activity Type,Scenario Simulation,Email Drafting,Speech Writing,Role Play,Register Shift Field,Activity 16,Activity 17,Activity 18,Activity 19,Activity 20

Title,The Storm Report,The Strategic Choice,The Research Lab,The Logistic Setup,The Professional Apology

Skill,Writing,Speaking,Writing,Writing,Writing

Subskill,Damage Assessment,Decision Making,Scientific Reporting,Event Planning,Conflict Resolution

CEFR Level,C1,C2,C2,C1,C1

Objective,"Use ""do"" for damage/harm.", "Use ""make"" for decisions.", "Use ""do"" for experiments.", "Use ""make"" for arrangements.", "Use ""make"" for errors."

Instructions,Evaluate and report the structural harm caused to a facility after a weather event.,Analyze and select between two competing long-term corporate strategies.,Document a scientific trial regarding chemical reactions in the laboratory.,Coordinate the complex logistical requirements for a visiting delegation.,Draft a formal admission of a financial discrepancy to a key stakeholder.

Task Prompt,"""The storm broke the roof.""", """"I have to choose between two careers.""", """"We are testing how metal reacts with water.""", """"The school can organize things for pupils.""", """"We were mistaken in your bill."""

Expected Answer,The storm did some damage to the roof.,I have to make a choice between these two career paths.,We are doing an experiment on metal.,The school can make arrangements for pupils.,We made a mistake in your bill.

Difficulty,Advanced,Mastery,Mastery,Advanced,Advanced

Activity Type,Incident Reporting,Decision Analysis,Scientific Writing,Memo Drafting,Error Correction

Precision with these high-frequency verbs ensures that the speaker's message is not just understood, but respected for its naturalness and professional weight, providing a bridge into the more abstract world of metaphorical framing.

3. Module 3: Metaphorical Framing & Rhetorical Flair

Metaphors play a vital cognitive role in English, allowing complex social and emotional dynamics to be described through imagery of the physical world. Collocations involving "Water," "Fire," and "Light/Dark" enable a speaker to move beyond literal descriptions toward a more sophisticated narrative. Describing a meeting where "ideas flowed" or a "heated debate" occurred provides a vividness that literal language lacks. These tools are essential for board

meetings and negotiations, where the "temperature" of the room or the "flow" of information is as important as the facts themselves.

Activities 21–30: Rhetorical Imagery

Field, Activity 21, Activity 22, Activity 23, Activity 24, Activity 25

Title, The Successful Brainstorm, The Conflict Narrative, The Recognition Gala, The Mood

Shift, The Empathy Description

Skill, Speaking, Writing, Speaking, Speaking, Writing

Subskill, Collaborative Success, Conflict Analysis, Awards Ceremony, Team

Management, Descriptive Writing

CEFR Level, C1, C2, C1, C1, C1

Objective, "Apply ""Water"" metaphors.", "Apply ""Fire"" metaphors.", "Apply ""Light"" metaphors.", "Apply ""Light/Dark"" metaphors.", "Apply ""Water"" metaphors."

Instructions, Describe a highly productive session where innovation was easy and constant., Analyze a high-intensity disagreement between senior management., Describe the physical reaction of a researcher receiving a major accolade., Suggest a team-building initiative to improve the collective mood of the office., Describe the profound emotional distress of a child in a humanitarian report.

Task Prompt, ""The meeting was good; we had many ideas moving easily."" , ""The two managers argued very angrily."" , ""Her eyes looked happy when she won."" , ""Let's make the atmosphere more relaxed."" , ""The little girl was crying a lot.""

Expected Answer, The meeting was successful; the ideas flowed ., They had a heated discussion about the budget., Her eyes shone with excitement ., Let's put on music to lighten the atmosphere ., She was in floods of tears .

Difficulty, Advanced, Mastery, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced

Activity Type, Scenario Simulation, Narrative Upgrade, Public Speaking, Role Play, Creative Writing

Field, Activity 26, Activity 27, Activity 28, Activity 29, Activity 30

Title, The Crowd Dynamics, The Sudden Outbreak, The Social Blunder, The Career Peak, The Traffic Report

Skill, Writing, Writing, Speaking, Writing, Writing

Subskill, Event Management, Crisis Reporting, Interpersonal Skills, Profile Writing, Logistics

CEFR Level, C2, C2, C1, C1, C1

Objective, "Use ""Water"" flow terms.", "Use ""Fire"" flare terms.", "Use ""Fire"" heat terms.", "Use ""Fire"" fire terms.", "Use ""Water"" stream terms."

Instructions, Describe the mass exit of an audience from a lecture hall., Report on the sudden resurgence of civil unrest in a capital city., Describe a moment of extreme social shame during a diplomatic dinner., "Describe the final, spectacular achievement of a retiring executive.", "Report on the continuous, heavy movement of vehicles past a site."

Task Prompt, ""Everyone came out of the hall at once."" , ""The violence started again suddenly."" , ""I felt very embarrassed and my face felt hot."" , ""She ended her career with a great success."" , ""There were many cars moving all night.""

Expected Answer, People poured out of the hall., Violence flared up in the capital., My cheeks burned with embarrassment ., She ended in a blaze of glory ., There was a stream of traffic all night.

Difficulty,Mastery,Mastery,Advanced,Advanced,Advanced

Activity Type,Descriptive Report,News Briefing,Personal Narrative,Narrative Upgrade,Logistical Report

Linguist's Note on Semantic Prosody: Choosing a metaphor like "tempers flared" rather than "people got angry" changes the narrative impact by suggesting a sudden, bright intensity—much like a fire catching—which implies the situation was potentially volatile and difficult to contain. This rhetorical flair allows professionals to frame corporate strategy with a sense of urgency and scale.

4. Module 4: Corporate Strategy, Finance & Market Dynamics

In the corporate world, linguistic precision is synonymous with credibility. The strategic value of collocations like "submit a tender," "raise capital," and "go into partnership" lies in their ability to signal expertise in market dynamics. Establishing a business is not just about "starting a company"; it is about "launching a product" or "setting up a business" to "make a profit." These collocations are the currency of the marketplace, and their correct usage is vital for navigating finance and competitive strategy.

Activities 31–40: Market Mastery

Field,Activity 31,Activity 32,Activity 33,Activity 34,Activity 35

Title,The Profit Margin,The Strategic Alliance,The Market Entry,The Funding Round,The Bid Proposal

Skill,Writing,Speaking,Writing,Speaking,Writing

Subskill,Financial Reporting,Business Development,Marketing,Corporate Finance,Procurement
CEFR Level,C1,C2,C1,C2,C2

Objective,"Differentiate ""make"" vs ""earn.""",Apply partnership terms.,Use product introduction terms.,Use capital acquisition terms.,Apply tender terminology.

Instructions,Report on the company's annual net earnings for the fiscal year.,Propose a formal joint venture to a potential international partner.,Synthesize an announcement for a new product introduction.,Brief investors on the necessity of acquiring new growth funds.,Formally describe the process of offering a contract price for a public works project.

Task Prompt,"""The company got more money than it spent.""",""We should work together with them as partners.""",""We will introduce the new phone in June.""",""We need to get money to grow the firm.""",""We sent a document with our price for the project.""

Expected Answer,The company made a profit .,We should go into partnership with them.,We will launch the product in June.,We need to raise capital .,We submitted a tender for the stadium.

Difficulty,Advanced,Mastery,Advanced,Mastery,Mastery

Activity Type,Financial Analysis,Strategy Proposal,Press Release,Scenario Simulation,Register Shift

Field,Activity 36,Activity 37,Activity 38,Activity 39,Activity 40

Title,The Corporate Merger,The Market Boom,The Growth Strategy,The Compensation Plan,The Competitive Victory

Skill,Writing,Speaking,Speaking,Writing,Writing

Subskill,Management,Economic Analysis,Business Strategy,HR/Payroll,Competitive Intelligence

CEFR Level,C1,C1,C2,C1,C2

Objective,"Use ""merge"" collocations.",Use economic growth terms.,Use expansion terms.,Differentiate ""salary"" vs ""profit.""",Use ""defeat"" vs ""win.""

Instructions,Describe the legal union of two major competitors.,Analyze the period of significant economic prosperity in the 1990s.,Present a strategy for the physical expansion of company branches.,Discuss the fixed monthly compensation of an executive.,Report on the successful outcome of a high-stakes competitive bid.

Task Prompt,"""The two companies joined in 2003.""",""The economy was very strong in the 90s.""",""The company got bigger and has more branches.""",""I get \$2000 a month for my work.""",""He won against his opponent in the final.""

Expected Answer,The two companies merged in 2003.,The economy boomed in the 1990s.,The company has expanded .,I earn a salary of \$2000.,He defeated his opponent in the final.

Difficulty,Advanced,Advanced,Mastery,Advanced,Mastery

Activity Type,Case Study,Market Review,Strategy Briefing,Contract Review,Sports/Business News

The precision required in financial and strategic collocations is mirrored in the rigors of academic critique and scholarly writing.

5. Module 5: Academic Synthesis & Scholarly Critique

Scholarly writing demands a specific set of collocations that maintain a formal, objective distance while precisely defining concepts. The distinction between "beginning" and "starting" is crucial; "begin" is preferred for formal, abstract contexts (e.g., "before the universe began"), while "start" is reserved for engines and vehicles. Similarly, "achieving goals" implies the realization of an abstract aim, whereas "gaining recognition" suggests the acquisition of a social benefit. Mastering these synonyms and "confusable words" is essential for synthesizing data or critiquing research.

Activities 41–50: Scholarly Precision

Field,Activity 41,Activity 42,Activity 43,Activity 44,Activity 45

Title,The Abstract Start,The Research Goal,The Social Standing,The Ancient Study,The Valued Object

Skill,Writing,Writing,Speaking,Writing,Writing

Subskill,Theory Development,Dissertation Planning,Academic Profile,History/Archaeology,Art History

CEFR Level,C2,C1,C1,C1,C1

Objective,"Use ""begin"" for abstracts.",Use ""achieve"" for aims.",Use ""gain"" for reputations.",Differentiate ""ancient"" vs ""antique.""",Use ""antique"" correctly."

Instructions,Formulate a theoretical statement regarding the origin of the universe.,State your primary research objectives for a doctoral thesis.,Discuss the emergence of a scholar's academic prominence.,Critique a paper that confuses historical eras with physical objects.,Describe a collection of high-value, historical furnishings."

Task Prompt, ""Before the world started, there was no time.", ""It is hard to get success in sports.", ""She got a reputation as a lawyer.", ""She studied very old history.", ""She collects very old and valuable furniture."

Expected Answer, "Before the universe began, time did not exist.", "It is difficult to achieve success.", "She gained a reputation as a lawyer.", "She studied ancient history.", "She collects antique furniture."

Difficulty, Mastery, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced

Activity Type, Synthesis Task, Goal Setting, Profile Analysis, Terminology Drill, Descriptive Writing Field, Activity 46, Activity 47, Activity 48, Activity 49, Activity 50

Title, The Meeting's End, The Survivor Story, The Unique Event, The Only Child, The Complete Task

Skill, Writing, Speaking, Speaking, Writing, Writing

Subskill, Administrative Writing, Narrative Synthesis, Event Planning, Sociology, Process Reporting CEFR Level, C1, C2, C2, C1, C1

Objective, "Use ""close"" for meetings.", "Use ""sole"" for survivors.", "Use ""unique"" for one-off events.", "Use ""only child"" correctly.", "Use ""finish"" vs ""end.""

Instructions, Formally document the conclusion of an administrative session., Synthesize a report on the singular person who lived through a catastrophe., Describe the significance of a meeting between three global leaders., Analyze the sociological impact of having no siblings., Report on the completion of a complex written assignment.

Task Prompt, ""The chairman stopped the meeting at 4:30.", ""She was the only person who lived through the crash.", ""This is a special one-time meeting.", ""I am a child with no brothers or sisters.", ""I have not completed my essay yet."

Expected Answer, "The chairperson closed the meeting at 4:30.", "She was the sole survivor.", "This is a unique occasion.", "I am an only child.", "I haven't finished my essay yet."

Difficulty, Advanced, Mastery, Mastery, Advanced, Advanced

Activity Type, Memo Drafting, Data Synthesis, Scenario Briefing, Case Study, Error Correction

The bridge between academic clarity and professional excellence lies in the application of these precise terms to the domains of law, policy, and diplomacy.

6. Module 6: Legal Framing, Policy & Public Diplomacy

Legal language serves as a "ground truth" for policy, where specific collocations function as performative utterances—words that carry the weight of law. Terms like "trespassers will be prosecuted" and "strictly forbidden" are not mere suggestions; they are regulatory mandates. In public safety announcements or regulatory frameworks, evaluating the weight of "strictly forbidden" versus "strongly discouraged" is a vital skill for policy-makers and diplomats who must ensure compliance through precise framing.

Activities 51–60: Regulatory Rigor

Field, Activity 51, Activity 52, Activity 53, Activity 54, Activity 55

Title, Prohibitive Weight, The Exit Mandate, The Safety Notice, The Legal Warning, The Infrastructure Rule

Skill, Writing, Speaking, Writing, Writing, Writing

Subskill,Policy Analysis,Public Briefing,Regulatory Signage,Law Enforcement,Infrastructure Policy

CEFR Level,C2,C1,C2,C1,C1

Objective,Evaluate legal weight of prohibition., "Use ""alight from"" formally.", "Use ""dispose of"" correctly.", "Use ""prosecuted"" correctly.", "Use ""dismount"" correctly."

Instructions, "Evaluate the performative strength of ""strictly forbidden"" vs ""strongly discouraged"" in a safety ban.", "Formally instruct passengers on a public transit vehicle regarding safety.", "Draft a regulatory warning for the disposal of hazardous materials.", "Formulate a legal warning against unauthorized entry on private property.", "Draft an official rule for a municipal footbridge."

Task Prompt, "Analyze why a policy would use ""strictly forbidden"" over ""strongly discouraged.""", """"Get off the bus at the back door.""", """"Don't throw away batteries in a fire.""", """"If you come in here without asking, we will take you to court.""", """"Bikers should get off before crossing."""

Expected Answer, """" Strictly forbidden "" carries a performative legal mandate; "" strongly discouraged "" is merely a recommendation.", "Passengers must alight from the bus through the rear door.", "Never dispose of batteries by throwing them into a fire.", "Trespassers will be prosecuted .", "Cyclists should dismount before crossing."

Difficulty,Mastery,Advanced,Mastery,Advanced,Advanced

Activity Type,Legal Critique,Role Play,Policy Drafting,Legal Framing,Signage Upgrade Field,Activity 56,Activity 57,Activity 58,Activity 59,Activity 60

Title,Judicial Integrity,Diplomatic Success,The Ethics Crisis,Criminal Sociology,The Procurement Bid

Skill,Writing,Speaking,Speaking,Writing,Writing

Subskill,Judicial Reporting,Political Briefing,Management Ethics,Sociology of Crime,Finance Law

CEFR Level,C2,C2,C2,C1,C2

Objective, "Use ""fair trial.""", "Use ""win an election/battle.""", "Use ""bend the rules.""", "Use ""break the law.""", "Use ""submit a tender.""

Instructions, "Evaluate the judicial process of a high-profile international case.", "Brief a diplomatic team on the outcome of a foreign general election.", "Discuss a situation where a manager bypassed protocol without illegal acts.", "Describe an act of legal non-compliance in a social report.", "Formulate a report on the formal bidding process for a state infrastructure project."

Task Prompt, """"He had a good and honest trial.""", """"The party was successful in the 1994 general election.""", """"He didn't break the law but he changed the rules slightly.""", """"She did something illegal.""", """"They sent an official price for the job."""

Expected Answer, "He received a fair trial .", "The party won the general election .", "He bent the rules .", "She broke the law .", "They submitted a tender ."

Difficulty,Mastery,Mastery,Mastery,Advanced,Mastery

Activity Type,Legal Critique,Policy Proposal,Scenario Analysis,Register Shift,Financial Reporting

The human element of these policies—how they are communicated and enforced—brings us to the critical area of workplace relations and conflict resolution.

7. Module 7: Nuanced Workplace Relations & Conflict Resolution

In professional settings, the ability to navigate interpersonal dynamics is often a matter of selecting the right collocations for feelings and reactions. Using phrases like "have a row," "take a dislike to," or "burst into tears" allows a manager or HR professional to describe conflicts with precision. Conversely, positive collocations like "swelling with pride" or "lasting happiness" help in fostering a positive culture. Navigating these emotions requires a high level of "Mastery," especially when de-escalating a situation or providing sensitive feedback.

Activities 61–70: Interpersonal Dynamics

Field, Activity 61, Activity 62, Activity 63, Activity 64, Activity 65

Title, The Departmental Row, The Emotional Outburst, The Success Feeling, The Ethical Crisis, Supervisor Hostility

Skill, Speaking, Writing, Writing, Writing, Speaking

Subskill, Mediation, HR Reporting, Internal Comms, Crisis Management, Conflict Resolution

CEFR Level, C1, C1, C1, C2, C2

Objective, "Use ""have a row.""", "Use ""burst into tears.""", "Use ""swelling with pride.""", "Use ""filled with horror.""", "Use ""take a dislike to."""

Instructions, Mediate between two colleagues who had a significant verbal disagreement., Document a subordinate's emotional reaction to the delivery of bad news., Describe a manager's reaction to their team's breakthrough achievement., Analyze the psychological state of an observer witnessing a disaster., Synthesize a report on a subordinate's perception of a supervisor's growing hostility.

Task Prompt, ""They had a big argument about the company car.""", ""She suddenly started crying.""", ""He was looking extremely proud.""", ""I was extremely shocked and scared.""", ""The boss doesn't like the new employee.""

Expected Answer, They had a row about the car., She burst into tears ., He was swelling with pride ., I was filled with horror ., The boss has taken a dislike to you.

Difficulty, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced, Mastery, Mastery

Activity Type, Role Play, Incident Report, Descriptive Writing, Narrative Upgrade, Conflict Analysis

Field, Activity 66, Activity 67, Activity 68, Activity 69, Activity 70

Title, Institutional Joy, The Stress Analysis, The Clinical Wreck, The Patience Limit, The Creative Mind

Skill, Writing, Speaking, Speaking, Speaking, Writing

Subskill, Well-being, Wellness Briefing, Counseling, Management, Team Building

CEFR Level, C1, C1, C2, C1, C1

Objective, "Use ""lasting happiness.""", "Use ""worried sick.""", "Use ""emotional wreck.""", "Use ""lose your patience.""", "Use ""vivid imagination."""

Instructions, "Describe a stable, positive psychological state in a workplace wellness survey.", "Communicate extreme professional anxiety regarding a pending audit.", "Analyze the state of a lead researcher who is broken by stress.", "Instruct a new manager on how to maintain composure during a difficult audit.", "Profile a creative employee's ability to generate original ideas.

Task Prompt, ""She felt happy for a long time."" , ""I am very, very worried about the audit."" , ""He is a person who is broken by emotions."" , ""Don't get angry with the staff."" , ""He has a very good and active imagination.""

Expected Answer, She found lasting happiness ., I am worried sick about the audit., He is an emotional wreck ., Don't lose your patience ., He has a vivid imagination .

Difficulty, Advanced, Advanced, Mastery, Advanced, Advanced

Activity Type, Case Study, Personal Narrative, Situation Briefing, Role Play, Profile Writing

Shifting focus from internal relations, we move toward the external world of media and the linguistic shorthand used in journalism.

8. Module 8: Investigative Journalism & Media Analysis

Journalism relies on a linguistic shorthand—collocations that convey urgency, scale, and drama. "Newspaper English" often utilizes weather metaphors ("freak storms," "driving rain") and punchy action verbs ("hit the headlines," "crack down") to create a narrative that is both efficient and impactful. For a C2-level learner, the ability to rewrite standard, "boring" sentences into a dramatic media style is a key indicator of communicative mastery.

Activities 71–80: Media Shorthand

Field, Activity 71, Activity 72, Activity 73, Activity 74, Activity 75

Title, The Front Page, Sudden Destruction, The Driving Force, The Flood Alert, Gale-Force Alert

Skill, Writing, Writing, Writing, Writing, Writing

Subskill, Headline Writing, News Briefing, Weather Reporting, Disaster Analysis, Meteorology

CEFR Level, C1, C2, C1, C1, C2

Objective, "Use ""hit the headlines.""", "Use ""freak storms.""", "Use ""driving rain.""", "Use ""burst their banks.""", "Use ""gale-force winds.""

Instructions, Describe a minor corporate scandal that has become national news., Report on highly unusual and destructive weather conditions., Describe rain falling fast and heavily during a logistics delay., Report on the flooding caused by rivers overflowing., Describe the impact of extremely strong winds on local property.

Task Prompt, ""The story was in all the newspapers today."" , ""Very unusual storms hit the south."" , ""It was raining fast and heavily."" , ""The rivers went over their sides."" , ""The wind was extremely strong.""

Expected Answer, The story hit the headlines ., Freak storms devastated the south., The conditions were due to driving rain ., Several rivers burst their banks ., Gale-force winds caused damage.

Difficulty, Advanced, Mastery, Advanced, Advanced, Mastery

Activity Type, Headline Upgrade, News Briefing, Descriptive Writing, Incident Report, Narrative Upgrade

Field, Activity 76, Activity 77, Activity 78, Activity 79, Activity 80

Title, The Job Axe, The Price Slash, The Budget Rocket, The Law Crackdown, The Suspect Quiz

Skill, Writing, Writing, Writing, Writing, Writing

Subskill, Business News, Economic News, Financial News, Crime Reporting, Investigative News

CEFR Level, C1, C1, C1, C1, C1

Objective, "Use ""axe jobs.""", "Use ""slashes prices.""", "Use ""rocket.""", "Use ""crack down.""", "Use ""quiz."""

Instructions, Report on a major factory closure and subsequent redundancies., Announce a drastic reduction in fuel costs by a major provider., Forecast a rapid and significant increase in public spending., Report on a more severe police strategy against speeding., Report on the investigative questioning of a prime suspect.

Task Prompt, ""The factory will make 200 people redundant.""", ""The oil company lowered prices a lot.""", ""Government spending will go up fast.""", ""Police will be more severe on speeders.""", ""Police asked the man questions.""

Expected Answer, ""FACTORY TO AXE JOBS """, ""COMPANY SLASHES PRICES """, ""SPENDING WILL ROCKET """, ""POLICE CRACK DOWN ON SPEEDERS""", ""POLICE QUIZ SUSPECT""

Difficulty, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced

Activity Type, Register Shift, Register Shift, Register Shift, Register Shift, Register Shift

Beyond the drama of headlines lies the data-heavy side of media—the quantitative analysis of trends and market movements.

9. Module 9: Quantitative Dynamics & Trend Analysis

The language of change and movement is essential for describing market trends and quantitative shifts. Metaphors from the natural world, such as "weather deteriorates" or "prices rocket," serve as templates for economic analysis. Understanding how a "biting wind" or "heavy snow" can serve as a metaphor for economic downturns, while a "wind picking up" signals a positive trend, allows for a more nuanced interpretation of data.

Activities 81–90: Trend Terminology

Field, Activity 81, Activity 82, Activity 83, Activity 84, Activity 85

Title, The Market Decline, The Momentum Shift, The Inflation Spike, The Growth Phase, The Corporate Expansion

Skill, Writing, Writing, Speaking, Writing, Writing

Subskill, Economic Reporting, Trend Analysis, Financial Briefing, Business History, Strategy Report

CEFR Level, C1, C1, C1, C1, C1

Objective, "Use ""deteriorate"" formally.", "Use ""wind picks up.""", "Use ""prices soar.""", "Use ""economy boomed.""", "Use ""company expanded.""

Instructions, Formulate a formal warning about worsening market conditions., Describe a trend that is gaining strength., Present a briefing on rapidly rising costs., Analyze the strong economy of the 1990s., Formulate a report on a company's physical growth.

Task Prompt, ""The market conditions are getting worse.""", ""The trend is starting to get stronger.""", ""The price of oil is going up very fast.""", ""The economy was very strong.""", ""The company got much bigger.""

Expected Answer, The market is likely to deteriorate . Justification: 'Deteriorate' maintains formal register over 'get worse.' The trend is picking up now. Justification: Natural idiomatic movement for trends., Prices have soared . Justification: Conveys the height and speed of the increase., The economy boomed . Justification: Standard economic term for rapid growth., The company has expanded . Justification: Precise term for corporate growth.

Difficulty,Advanced,Advanced,Advanced,Advanced,Advanced
 Activity Type,Register Shift,Metaphorical Analysis,Scenario Simulation,Case Study,Trend Report
 Field,Activity 86,Activity 87,Activity 88,Activity 89,Activity 90
 Title,The Economic Chill,The Frozen Market,The Vision Blur,The Cost Rocket,The Rapid Rise
 Skill,Writing,Writing,Writing,Writing,Writing
 Subskill,Market Analysis,Economic Forecast,Qualitative Analysis,Consumer News,Data Analysis
 CEFR Level,C2,C2,C2,C1,C1
 Objective,"Use ""biting winds.""", "Use ""hard frost.""", "Use ""patches of fog.""", "Use ""prices rocket.""", "Use ""sharp rise."""
 Instructions,Use metaphorical weather terms to describe a harsh economic climate.,Describe a completely stagnant market using a winter metaphor.,Describe areas of confusion in complex data., "Announce a sudden, explosive increase in consumer costs.", "Report on a sudden, significant increase in a statistical graph."
 Task Prompt,"""The economic situation is very cold.""", ""The market has stopped completely like ice.""", ""There are areas where we can't see the truth.""", ""The costs are going up like a firework.""", ""There was a fast and big increase.""
 Expected Answer,We face biting winds in the economy. Justification: Conveys the painful nature of the downturn.,There will be a hard frost in the market. Justification: Metaphor for complete lack of activity.,There are patches of fog in the data. Justification: Suggests localized lack of clarity.,Prices will rocket this year. Justification: Captures the speed and dramatic impact.,There was a sharp rise in numbers. Justification: Standard analytical term for sudden increases.
 Difficulty,Mastery,Mastery,Mastery,Advanced,Advanced
 Activity Type,Metaphorical Analysis,Scenario Analysis,Data Critique,Register Shift,Trend Report
 The final step of the master framework involves the study of the words themselves—the lexicographical meta-skills that allow for self-correction and corpus editing.

10. Module 10: Lexicographical Discovery & Corpus Editing

Mastery at the C2 level requires more than just knowing collocations; it requires an understanding of how they are constructed and categorized. Distinguishing between "compounds" (e.g., *car park*), "idioms" (e.g., *pass the buck*), and "collocations" is an essential meta-skill. Furthermore, developing "Corpus Editing" skills—the ability to identify and correct collocation errors like "get bald" instead of "go bald"—marks the transition from a learner to a linguistic expert.

Activities 91–100: Lexicographical Mastery

Field,Activity 91,Activity 92,Activity 93,Activity 94,Activity 95
 Title,The Appearance Shift,The Morning Routine,The Choice Correction,The Effort Fix,The Academic Edit
 Skill,Writing,Writing,Writing,Writing,Writing
 Subskill,Self-Correction,Proofreading,Editing,Editing,Editing
 CEFR Level,C2,C1,C1,C1,C1

Objective, "Use ""go"" for physical changes.", "Fix ""make"" vs ""do"" (Source 2.3).", Fix decision collocations., Fix effort collocations., Fix research collocations.

Instructions, Correct a sentence regarding the physical aging process of male hair., Identify and correct the eight collocation errors in the provided morning narrative (Source 2.3)., Correct a sentence regarding the act of making a choice., Correct a sentence regarding attempting a task with intensity., Correct a sentence regarding academic study.

Task Prompt, ""Men get bald as they get older."" , ""In the morning I made some work in the garden..."" , ""I had to do a decision."" , ""I wanted to do a special effort."" , ""I am making research.""

Expected Answer, Men go bald . Rule: Go is used for changes in appearance., In the morning I did some work . Rule: Do for activities/work., I had to make a decision ., I wanted to make an effort ., I am doing research .

Difficulty, Mastery, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced, Advanced

Activity Type, Corpus Editing, Error Correction, Error Correction, Error Correction, Error Correction
Field, Activity 96, Activity 97, Activity 98, Activity 99, Activity 100

Title, The Compound Check, The Idiom Audit, The Health Edit, The Strategic Edit, The Final Assessment

Skill, Writing, Writing, Writing, Writing, Writing

Subskill, Categorization, Categorization, Proofreading, Business Editing, Final Review

CEFR Level, C1, C2, C1, C2, C2

Objective, Identify compounds., Identify idioms., Fix illness collocations., Fix partnership terms., Fix goal collocations.

Instructions, Distinguish between a collocation and a compound word., Distinguish between a literal collocation and an idiom., Correct a sentence regarding falling ill., Correct a sentence regarding a joint venture., Correct a sentence regarding life ambitions.

Task Prompt, "Choose the compound: ""Ancient monument"" or ""Car park.""", "Choose the idiom: ""Pass the buck"" or ""Make an effort.""", ""My grandmother got ill."" , ""We made a partnership."" , ""I did my lifelong ambition.""

Expected Answer, Car park . Rule: A unit of meaning often written as two words., Pass the buck . Rule: A fixed phrase with non-literal meaning., My grandmother fell ill ., We went into partnership ., I achieved my ambition .

Difficulty, Advanced, Mastery, Advanced, Mastery, Mastery

Activity Type, Categorization, Categorization, Error Correction, Corpus Editing, Final Assessment

This framework completes the journey from a basic understanding of word pairs to a sophisticated lexicographical expertise, enabling the learner to navigate the English language with the precision and authority of a native-level professional.